

THE SEEKING ROOM

*A Devotional Planner for the Woman Choosing
God Jesus Christ Over the Noise*

By Rhina Jasmyn

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A Note Before You Begin

I did not write this planner because of something I observed in other women. I wrote it because of what I lived.

I came out of a marriage marked by narcissism and infidelity — adultery, and a pattern that repeated because there was never any true repentance behind the apologies. There were words. There were promises. There was never a turning. And a woman can survive almost anything except a cycle that never breaks.

When it ended, I was left with questions I did not know how to ask out loud. **That season was lonely. It was frightening. It was heavy in a way I could not explain to most people — and I learned quickly that not everyone is equipped to carry what you are carrying.** You cannot hand your rawest wound to just anyone. It took prayer. It took a real relationship with Jesus Christ. It took the right mentors, and there were very few of them.

And it took time. I am still walking this out by faith today.

So let me say clearly what this planner is not. **I am not celebrating divorce. Not for one moment.** Good men exist. Good marriages exist. I have a son who loves the Lord, and I believe with my whole heart that God is preparing a wife for him — a covenant where two people honor and respect one another, where Christ is the center and not an afterthought. I still have hope. I have never stopped having hope.

But our choices carry consequences, and they do not stop at us. **When something begins in sin, when a woman is unequally yoked, when God is not at the center of the union — there is a domino effect, and it falls across children, finances, health, and years.** An unequal yoke is not from God (2 Corinthians 6:14). It never was. Our choices matter. And who you marry matters most of all.

I say this not to condemn any woman reading it, because I am the woman reading it. I say it because I lived the consequence, and I would spare you the years it cost me.

This planner is my testimony. Every section is a room I actually sat in — the grief, the battle in my mind, the surrender, the wrong voices I let too close, the chain I could not break on my own, the private hours nobody saw, the vision I was afraid to write down, the seeking that had no end, the blessing I thought had passed me by, and the boundaries I did not know God Himself had authored.

This is not a feel-sorry-for-yourself planner, and it is not a shortcut. This is a place to seek Jesus Christ until He answers — the only way that actually holds when life gets hard again. There are no shortcuts to becoming the kind of woman who hears God's voice clearly enough to recognize a counterfeit when it walks through her door. I know. I looked for one.

This is the unglamorous hour nobody claps for — the one where you show up before anyone is watching, and you let the Word of God do what only it can do.

THIS IS A RHYTHM, NOT A PROGRAM

Hear me clearly before you turn one more page: **this planner will not change you in seven days.** It was never built to. Anything that promises to rebuild a broken woman in a week is selling you the same shortcut I just warned you about.

What this planner will do is hand you a rhythm. A repeatable, unglamorous, ordinary rhythm of opening the Word, speaking to God, and letting Him speak back. You will walk through these sections and then you will walk through them again. And again. Not because you failed the first time, but because that is exactly how a habit is formed and exactly how a relationship is built.

You do not build a friendship in one conversation. You do not build a marriage in one dinner. And you will not build a life with Jesus Christ in one good quiet time. You build it by coming back. Healing is not an event you schedule. It is the fruit of a relationship you keep returning to — and it takes as long as it takes.

So take the pressure off. You are not behind. You are not failing. **The goal is not to finish this planner. The goal is to become a woman who never stops opening it.**

FOUR VOICES ON THE POWER OF REPETITION

VINCE LOMBARDI opened every single season the same way, no matter how many championships his team had already won. He held up the ball and said: “Gentlemen, this is a football.” Not because his players didn’t know what a football was — because greatness returns to the fundamentals, every time, with no shortcuts.

JOHN MAXWELL was once asked by a young graduate, “I want to do what you do.” Maxwell asked, “What do you think I do?” The young man listed the conferences, the stages, the income. Maxwell told him: “In order to do what I do, you have to know what I did. People are rewarded in public for what they practiced in private.”

TERRI SAVELLE FOY built a global ministry not on one viral moment, but on writing her vision down daily, for years, long before anyone was watching. She teaches that habits — practiced privately and repeated relentlessly — are what carry a woman into the promises of God.

KOBE BRYANT was already one of the greatest to ever play, and he was still the first one in the gym at 4am, running the same fundamental drills he ran as a rookie. Excellence was never about talent alone. It was repetition, even — especially — after success.

THE NAMES THIS AGE HAS GIVEN YOUR PAIN

We live in an era that hands a woman a label and then tells her the label is her name.

Depression dressed up as identity. Loneliness dressed up as destiny. Isolation renamed “protecting my peace.” Low self-esteem renamed “being realistic about myself.” Shame renamed “self-awareness.” **None of these are who God says you are.**

Let us define what this generation has renamed, because a thing you cannot name is a thing you cannot fight:

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
DEPRESSION	A real and heavy affliction of body, mind, and spirit. It is not a sin and it is not a character flaw. The enemy cannot create it, but he will exploit it — and his whole strategy is to convince you it is permanent and it is who you are.
LONELINESS	The ache of being unseen. The enemy loves it because it was the one thing God called “not good” before sin ever entered the world (Genesis 2:18). A woman alone is a woman he can talk to without interruption.
ISOLATION	What loneliness becomes when we agree with it. Loneliness happens to you. Isolation is chosen. The enemy will make the second one feel like wisdom, safety, and self-care.
LOW SELF-ESTEEM	A modern name for agreeing with the accuser about yourself. Not humility. Humility says God is great. This says God made a mistake, and He made it when He made me.
SHAME	The lie that you are not a woman who did a bad thing, but a woman who IS a bad thing. Guilt says I did wrong. Shame says I am wrong. Only one of them leads to repentance.

Hear me carefully, because I refuse to be careless with your life. I am not telling you that a diagnosis is a demon. Depression can be a genuine illness of the body. A woman may need a doctor, a counselor, medication, or all three — and seeking that help is not a failure of faith. It is wisdom. Luke was a physician. Paul told Timothy to take something for his stomach. God is not offended by medicine.

What I am telling you is that the enemy has a strategy, and the strategy is **isolation and identity**. He cannot take your salvation, so he works to take your name. He whispers: stay in the house. Do not call her back. You have always been this way. You will always be this way. This is simply who you are now.

That voice is a liar and it has a name. **He is called the accuser of the brethren (Revelation 12:10), and Scripture says he accuses us day and night.** Notice: he is not called the wounder. He is called the accuser. His weapon is not your pain. His weapon is what he says about you because of your pain.

So we do what Jesus did in the wilderness. We do not argue with him. **We answer him with what is written.**

This is not the place to nurse that voice. This is the place to drown it out with the Word — one page, one habit, one undated morning at a time.

You don't need a date on this calendar because you don't need permission to start today, whatever day you're holding this.

My prayer is that you become a true prayer warrior — a woman whose discernment is so sharpened by the Word that no counterfeit can fool you again. **Not because someone told you what to watch for, but because you know His voice.** That is what He did for me. He will do it for you. Begin.

How To Use This Planner

Read this page slowly. It will save you a lot of frustration later.

- There are no dates. Start on whatever page matches where you are today.
- Each section includes: a scripture, a word from Rhina, a deeper study of the original Hebrew or Greek, reflection questions, full journal space, a prayer, and a declaration to speak out loud.
- Do not skip the declaration. Speaking it matters — your own ears need to hear your voice agree with God's Word.
- This is not a 7-day or 30-day program. Stay in a section as long as you need to. Return as many times as you need to.
- No pity parties. No "I'll feel better when ___ happens." This is a seeking room, not a waiting room.
- Keep a Bible and a concordance nearby. Look up every verse. Read the full chapter, not just the line.

WHY YOU WILL SEE MORE THAN ONE TRANSLATION

Throughout these pages you will see the same verse quoted in KJV, AMP, and NLT. This is not to confuse you. Every faithful translation is carrying the same truth across a bridge from Hebrew and Greek into English — but each one carries a different part of the load.

KJV holds the weight and the reverence. AMP opens the word up and shows you the shades of meaning packed inside it. NLT hands you the plain sense so your heart can receive it on a hard day. Read all three and you will begin to see the shape of what God actually said — more than any single English word could hold.

And when we go into the Hebrew or the Greek, we are not being fancy. We are doing what God invited us to do: dig. A single word in the original often carries a whole world that English flattens into one syllable. That is where the treasure is.

THE RHYTHM OF EACH SECTION

- READ the scripture out loud, in more than one translation.
- SIT with the word from Rhina. Underline what stings. That is usually where God is working.
- DIG into the original language study. Ask what God meant, not just what the English says.
- ANSWER the reflection questions honestly. Nobody is grading this.
- PRAY the prayer. Then pray your own.
- SPEAK the declaration out loud. Out loud.
- RETURN. Tomorrow, next week, next season. That is the whole point.

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Section One — Name It Without Shame

Grief: divorce, loss of friendship, betrayal, abuse, disappointment

“The Lord is near to the heartbroken and He saves those who are crushed in spirit (contrite in heart, truly sorry for their sin).”

— Psalm 34:18 AMP

“The Lord is nigh unto them that are of a broken heart; and saveth such as be of a contrite spirit.”

— Psalm 34:18 KJV

“The Lord is close to the brokenhearted; he rescues those whose spirits are crushed.”

— Psalm 34:18 NLT

A WORD FROM RHINA

Heartbreak doesn't only come from a marriage ending. It comes from the friend who stopped calling. The job that let you go without warning. The dream that died quietly while everyone else's moved forward. Grief doesn't ask permission and it doesn't follow a schedule.

Divorce can feel like a death. Betrayal cuts deep. Abuse leaves scars. Disappointment and the ending of close friendships — these are all losses we must grieve. It is okay to mourn. It is normal. But there is a time limit. We are not meant to carry it forever.

Here is what I need you to hear: **depression is not a personality trait God Jesus Christ gave you, and it is not a life sentence.** What you are feeling is real — but the spirit behind it that tells you to stay there, to make a home out of the pain, to call it your identity — that is not from God. Name the loss clearly. Then refuse to set up camp in it.

We forgive and release — not for the person who hurt us, but for our own freedom. We bind every evil spirit of bitterness, grief, and hopelessness in the name of Jesus. We take every thought captive and make it obedient to Christ (2 Corinthians 10:5). When we open the door to endless rumination, when we fail to take thoughts captive, that is when grief turns into deep sadness, depression, failure, and hopelessness.

Know this: God sometimes removes what does not belong to us because Jesus has something far better prepared. He is not punishing you — He is positioning you.

Look at the story of **Job**. In one day he lost his children, his wealth, his health, and his reputation. His friends accused him. His wife told him to curse God and die. Yet in the middle of his greatest loss, Job declared, **“Though He kills me, I will hope in Him.”** (Job 13:15 AMP). He grieved honestly, but he did not build his home in bitterness. God restored him double — and used his story to encourage generations.

Another powerful example is the widow in **1 Kings 17**. She had lost everything and was preparing to die with her son. But when she obeyed the word of the Lord through Elijah, God supernaturally provided. Her obedience in the middle of loss opened the door for miracles.

This is your moment to be honest. Bring every detail before God — the betrayal, the disappointment, the anger, the bitterness. Lay it at the feet of Jesus. He is near to the brokenhearted (Psalm 34:18). He heals what we are willing to name and release.

You are allowed to grieve. You are not allowed to live there. God Jesus Christ is already making a way. Get up, take your thoughts captive, and walk forward into the better He has prepared.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

English gives you “brokenhearted” and “crushed.” Hebrew gives you something far more physical, and far more comforting.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>shabar</i> (שָׁבַר)	To break, to shatter, to fracture. Used of a bone snapping and of a clay jar smashed on stone. God is not near to the mildly disappointed. He is near to the shattered.
<i>leb</i> (לֵב)	Heart — but in Hebrew, this is the whole inner person: mind, will, emotions, decision-making. “Brokenhearted” means your entire inner life has fractured. God knows.
<i>daka</i> (דָּכָא)	Crushed, pulverized, ground into dust. The same root describes grain beaten in a mortar. He does not despise the powder. He saves it.
<i>qarob</i> (קָרִיב)	Near — not near as in “in the general area.” It is the word for a close relative who has the legal right and duty to redeem you. Nearness with obligation. He is near, and He is committed.
<i>yasha</i> (יָשָׁע)	Saves, delivers, rescues, gives victory. This is the root behind the name Yeshua — Jesus. The verse literally says: the shattered are saved by the One whose name is salvation.

Read that last line again. **Psalm 34:18 has the name of Jesus buried inside its final verb.** David did not know it yet. You do.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Charles Spurgeon preached that God does not break the heart in order to be cruel, but because a broken heart is the only kind that can be poured out. Wholeness that has never been shattered has nowhere for grace to enter.

C.S. Lewis, writing after losing his wife, admitted that grief felt so much like fear that he kept swallowing. He did not spiritualize it away. He wrote it down honestly — and God met him in the honesty, not in the performance.

Nicholas Wolterstorff, a Christian philosopher who lost his son, made this distinction that may set you free today: mourning is love refusing to let go of what it lost. Despair is love giving up on what remains. God permits the first. He came to rescue you from the second.

REFLECTION

1. What specifically did you lose? Name it plainly and honestly — no softening it, no spiritualizing it away. Write the raw truth.
2. What have you been calling “depression,” “my new normal,” or “who I am now” that is actually grief looking for an exit? What label have you given your pain that God never put on you?
3. What is the difference between feeling the pain and living inside it? Where have you crossed the line from healthy grieving into making a home in your heartbreak?
4. The word for “near” means a close relative obligated to redeem you. What changes if God is not watching your grief from a distance, but standing inside it with legal claim to rescue you?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF HONEST NAMING

Jesus Christ, I stop pretending. I bring You the actual loss, the actual name, the actual date it happened. I will not dress it up and I will not bury it. You are near to the shattered, and I am shattered. Come close as my Redeemer, not as a stranger. I refuse to build a home in this grief. I grieve it, and then I hand it to You. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I am allowed to grieve. I am not allowed to live there. God Jesus Christ is near to me right now, and He is already healing what I am naming today.

Section Two — Guard the Gate: The Battle of the Mind

Your mind, what you feed it, and why lies stick more than truth

“And do not be conformed to this world, but be transformed and progressively changed by the renewing of your mind, so that you may prove what the will of God is, that which is good and acceptable and perfect.”

— Romans 12:2 AMP

“And be not conformed to this world: but be ye transformed by the renewing of your mind, that ye may prove what is that good, and acceptable, and perfect, will of God.”

— Romans 12:2 KJV

“Don’t copy the behavior and customs of this world, but let God transform you into a new person by changing the way you think.”

— Romans 12:2 NLT

A WORD FROM RHINA

Your mind is the gate to everything else — your faith, your habits, your future. What you let through that gate daily either builds you or buries you.

Here is the honest truth: most women believe one negative word faster than ten compliments. Someone calls you a failure once and it lodges in your chest for years. Someone calls you smart, chosen, wonderful — and you deflect it, apologize for it, reject it before it can land. That is not humility. That is a stronghold. The enemy does not need a wide-open door. He only needs a small crack — one lie repeated, unchallenged — to build a stronghold in your thinking.

Scripture is clear that we are not unaware of his schemes, and we are not unarmed against them. “We are destroying sophisticated arguments and every exalted and proud thing that sets itself up against the true knowledge of God, and we are taking every thought and purpose captive to the obedience of Christ.” (2 Corinthians 10:5 AMP). That word “destroying” is not gentle. It is warfare language. You have authority to tear down a thought before it becomes a belief, before a belief becomes an identity.

And know this: God Jesus Christ has already declared the blessing over your life and your mind. Deuteronomy 28:1-2 promises that if you diligently obey the voice of the Lord your God, the blessings will come upon you and overtake you. (*That is my paraphrase — read the verses yourself, slowly.*) The blessings of Deuteronomy 28 are not just financial — they cover your mind, your peace, your household, your future. The enemy wants you ignorant of that inheritance. Knowledge of the Word is what breaks his access.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>metamorphoo</i> (μεταμορφόω)	Transformed. This is the root of “metamorphosis.” It is the same word used when Jesus was transfigured on the mountain. Not redecorated — reconstituted. Caterpillar to butterfly. It is passive: God does it to you while you keep showing up.
<i>anakainosis</i> (ἀνακαίνωσις)	Renewing. Not a one-time replacement but a continual, ongoing renovation. Present tense. This is why you cannot do it in seven days.
<i>nous</i> (νοῦς)	Mind — the faculty of moral judgment and perception. Not your IQ. The lens you interpret reality through. Change the lens, and the whole world looks different.
<i>kathaireo</i> (καθαίρω)	Destroying / demolishing (2 Cor 10:5). A military siege term — to pull down a fortress wall. Thoughts are not fought with feelings. They are besieged with truth.
<i>aichmalotizo</i> (αἰχμαλωτίζω)	Take captive. Literally: to lead away at spearpoint as a prisoner of war. You do not politely ask a lie to leave. You march it out in chains.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Martin Luther said you cannot stop the birds from flying over your head, but you can stop them from building a nest in your hair. The thought arriving is not sin. The thought moving in is.

A.W. Tozer wrote that what comes into your mind when you think about God is the most important thing about you. Before you fix your thoughts about yourself, fix your thoughts about Him. The rest reorders itself.

John Owen put it bluntly: be killing sin, or it will be killing you. There is no third option and no neutral ground in the mind.

REFLECTION

1. What three thoughts repeat on a loop in your mind? Write them with no filter.
2. Mark each one: Truth or Lie.
3. Why do you think the negative words stick more than the positive ones? Be honest.
4. Find one scripture that speaks the opposite of each lie you identified. Write the reference next to the lie.
5. What are you consuming daily — people, apps, shows — that feeds anxiety instead of faith?
6. The Greek says renewal is continual, not instant. Where have you been quietly ashamed that you are not “over it” yet?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF AUTHORITY

In the name of Jesus Christ, I bind every negative, false, and tormenting thought assigned against my mind. Satan, I rebuke you and every spirit of fear, depression, and doubt — you have no authority here. I plead the blood of Jesus Christ over my mind, my home, and my future. I demolish every argument raised against the knowledge of God, and I lead every thought away captive into obedience to Christ. I am covered, I am chosen, and I walk in the authority Christ has already given me. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I take every thought captive and make it obedient to Christ. My mind is not a trash can. It is sacred ground, and today I guard the gate.

Section Three — Open Hands

Surrender: releasing your will and your timeline, not your safety

“Trust in and rely confidently on the Lord with all your heart and do not rely on your own insight or understanding. In all your ways know and acknowledge and recognize Him, and He will make your paths straight and smooth.”

— Proverbs 3:5–6 AMP

“Trust in the Lord with all thine heart; and lean not unto thine own understanding. In all thy ways acknowledge him, and he shall direct thy paths.”

— Proverbs 3:5–6 KJV

A WORD FROM RHINA

I thought I was surrendering for years. I was praying, going to church, asking God to fix it — while still gripping the steering wheel with both hands. Real surrender sounds like: *Lord, I didn't choose this, I don't like it, but I trust You more than I trust myself.*

Surrender is not staying in something harmful. God Jesus Christ asked me to release my will and my timeline — **not my safety**. Know the difference. (We will go much deeper into this in Section Ten.)

Surrendering to God is one of the hardest things we will ever do because it requires deep, unwavering faith. It takes time. You are not helping God — He doesn't need our help. This is exactly where so many of us fail. We say we surrender, but then we keep one hand on the situation, trying to steer, fix, or speed things up. We treat God like a partner who needs our assistance instead of the Sovereign King who already has the perfect plan.

The Bible is full of stories about surrender, but one of the most powerful is Abraham's willingness to sacrifice Isaac (Genesis 22). God asked Abraham to give up the very promise he had waited decades for — the son through whom God said He would build a great nation. Abraham didn't understand it. It didn't make sense. It looked like the end of everything God had promised. Yet Abraham rose early, took the wood, the fire, and the knife, and walked up the mountain in obedience. He fully surrendered what was most precious to him, trusting that God was able to raise the dead if necessary (Hebrews 11:19).

That kind of surrender doesn't happen overnight. It is a daily, sometimes hourly choice to release control, to stop striving, and to trust that God's ways are higher than ours. You are not releasing it so God can finally act — you are releasing it because He is already acting, and your part is to trust and obey.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>batach</i> (בטח)	Trust. The root picture is throwing your full body weight onto something, the way you fall backward into a chair without checking it first. Trust is not a feeling. It is a lean.
<i>sha'an</i> (שׂאן)	Lean not. The word for leaning on a staff you depend on to walk. God is not saying your understanding is worthless. He is saying it cannot hold your weight.
<i>yada</i> (יָדָע)	Acknowledge / know. The same verb used for the deepest intimacy between husband and wife. "In all your ways know Him" is not information. It is relationship.
<i>yashar</i> (יָשַׁר)	Make straight. To level, to smooth, to make passable. He does not promise a shorter road. He promises a walkable one.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Andrew Murray taught that surrender is not one heroic act but a posture: hands open, palms up, again this morning. You will surrender the same thing more than once. That is not failure. That is the shape of it.

Elisabeth Elliot, widowed twice, wrote that God has never promised to explain. He has promised to be with you. Surrender is releasing your right to an explanation.

REFLECTION

1. What are you still gripping that you know God is asking you to release?
2. What does surrender feel like in your body right now?
3. What has trying to control this cost you?
4. Surrender means releasing your will and your timeline — never your safety. Is what you are calling “surrender” actually endurance of something God never asked you to endure?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF OPEN HANDS

Jesus Christ, I open my hands. I release my timeline, my plan, and my need to understand why. I stop trying to help You. I lean the whole weight of my life on You because my own understanding cannot carry it. Make my path straight — not short, not easy, but walkable. And where I have called endurance “surrender,” show me the difference. In Jesus Christ’s name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

Not my will. Not my timing. Not my plan. I open my hands today and trust the One who already sees the end of this story.

Section Four — Choose Your Room

Community without codependency

“We do not know what to do, but our eyes are on You.”

— 2 Chronicles 20:12 AMP

“He who walks with wise men will be wise, but the companion of fools will suffer harm.”

— Proverbs 13:20 AMP

A WORD FROM RHINA

There is nothing wrong with community. There is everything wrong with handing your ears to the wrong person. I confided in someone I respected and walked away more broken than when I arrived. Not everyone who loves God is equipped to speak into your specific wound — and not everyone who asks how you're doing is safe with your real answer.

Do not replace waiting on God with waiting on Sunday, waiting on a group text, or waiting for someone to check on you. Seek Him first. Let people sharpen you — not pacify you.

We gather in Bible studies, Moms in Prayer groups, small circles, and friendships — and these are good and godly things. But the danger comes when these become our primary source instead of a support. God is calling us to depend on Him first. In desperate moments, our first instinct is often to pick up the phone. There is nothing wrong with reaching for support — but we must walk in discernment about who we confide in and how much we lean on them.

True community points you back to the throne. It encourages you to go before God yourself — to fast, to quiet the noise, to spend undistracted time in His presence until you hear from Him. Don't wait until Sunday to hear from Jesus, our Lord and Savior. The same Holy Spirit who moves in the gathering is available to you right now, in the secret place.

Remember the story of King Jehoshaphat in 2 Chronicles 20. A vast army was coming against Judah. Instead of panicking and immediately calling his allies or relying on his own strength, Jehoshaphat called the people to seek the Lord. He declared a fast. The entire community gathered, but their eyes were fixed on God. Jehoshaphat prayed, "We do not know what to do, but our eyes are on You" (2 Chronicles 20:12 AMP). God fought the battle for them.

Scripture to stand on: "Trust in and rely confidently on the Lord with all your heart and do not rely on your own insight or understanding. In all your ways know and acknowledge and recognize Him, and He will make your paths straight and smooth." — Proverbs 3:5-6 AMP

This is the balance we are called to: cherish community, but never let it replace the One who knows every detail of your heart.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>halak</i> (הלך)	Walks (Prov 13:20). Not a visit. A shared direction over distance. You are not becoming like the people you admire. You are becoming like the people you walk beside.
<i>chakam</i> (חכם)	Wise. In Hebrew, wisdom is a skill, like a craftsman's hands. Wise people are not the ones with the most opinions. They are the ones whose lives are built well.
<i>ra'a</i> (רע)	Suffer harm. Literally to be broken, shattered. Proverbs does not say the companion of fools will be mildly inconvenienced.
<i>koinonia</i> (κοινωνία)	The New Testament word for fellowship. It means shared ownership, partnership in a common enterprise. Real community has skin in the game. It is not an audience for your pain.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Dietrich Bonhoeffer warned that the person who loves their dream of community will destroy community, while the person who loves the people around them will build it. Stop grieving the circle you wish you had and steward the two safe people you actually have.

Bonhoeffer also wrote that the one who cannot be alone should beware of community, and the one who cannot be in community should beware of being alone. You need both rooms. Neither one saves you.

REFLECTION

1. Who have you been going to for counsel? List them honestly.
2. Do they point you to God's Word, or mostly their own opinions?
3. Who is pulling you backward instead of forward — even if their intentions seem good?
4. What boundary do you need to set this week about who has access to your story? (Section Ten will show you how.)
5. Is there anyone you have made your source instead of your support? What would it cost you to move them back into their right place?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF DISCERNMENT

Jesus Christ, You are my Source. Every person You have placed around me is a gift, but none of them is You. Give me discernment about who I open my heart to and how far. Show me who sharpens me and who only soothes me. Where I have handed someone the place that belongs to You, I take it back today and lay it at Your feet. Let my community push me toward Your throne, never away from it. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I will seek God first — not a group chat, not Sunday, not a person. My community sharpens me toward Him; it does not replace Him.

Section Five — Break the Chain

Freedom from needing a person to feel whole

“It was for freedom that Christ set us free; therefore keep standing firm and do not be subject again to a yoke of slavery.”

— Galatians 5:1 AMP

“For God did not give us a spirit of timidity or cowardice or fear, but of power and of love and of sound judgment and personal discipline.”

— 2 Timothy 1:7 AMP

A WORD FROM RHINA

Staying out of fear is not the same as walking in faith. Building your identity, your security, or your peace around another human being — even a good one — is building your house on sand. When the storm comes, that foundation will not hold.

Codependency wears many faces: financial dependence, emotional entanglement, the quiet terror of who you would be without them. God never designed you to need any person more than you need Him. You were redeemed from the curse (Galatians 3:13), but disobedience still carries consequences. When we continue in old patterns, we carry unnecessary weight and open doors the enemy loves to walk through.

This is deep because codependency is not just a “relationship issue.” It is a demonic stronghold — an evil spirit that masquerades as loyalty, love, or necessity. We must call it what it is. Being stuck in toxic cycles is a form of worshiping the wrong thing. The enemy wants you bound so you never fully walk in the freedom Christ paid for.

God wants you free. Look back to the very beginning. In Genesis, God created boundaries and called them good. He gave Adam and Eve access to the Tree of Life, but He clearly commanded them to stay away from the Tree of the Knowledge of Good and Evil. Boundaries were never meant to restrict life — they were meant to protect it. Violating God’s boundaries always leads to death and separation.

Jesus Himself modeled healthy boundaries. He did not stay in every toxic situation or force relationship with those who rejected Him. When the people of Nazareth tried to throw Him off a cliff, “He passed through their midst and went on His way” (Luke 4:30 AMP). When the Gadarenes begged Him to leave their region after He delivered the demon-possessed man, He got into the boat and departed (Mark 5:17-20). He spoke truth boldly, but He also withdrew from those who were hard-hearted or sought to control Him. Jesus never excused sin to keep the peace. He acknowledged it, called it out, and moved forward in obedience to the Father.

We must do the same. Covering up toxic behavior, making excuses, or staying “to feel better” or “for the sake of relationship” is not love — it is disobedience. Unequal yokes pull your heart away from God (2 Corinthians 6:14). Fear is not from God — “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power and of love and of a sound mind” (2 Timothy 1:7 AMP).

Breaking free requires real deliverance and daily discipline. You have authority in Christ Jesus. The same power that raised Him from the dead lives in you (Romans 8:11). Generational curses and patterns of codependency, fear, and idolatry can be broken in Jesus’ name. You do not have to repeat the sins of your fathers and mothers.

STAND ON THESE TRUTHS

- “It was for freedom that Christ set us free; therefore keep standing firm and do not be subject again to a yoke of slavery.” (Galatians 5:1 AMP)
- “So submit to God. Resist the devil and he will flee from you.” (James 4:7 AMP)
- “Listen carefully, I have given you authority to tread on serpents and scorpions, and authority over all the power of the enemy; and nothing will injure you.” (Luke 10:19 AMP)

Fast. Pray. Renew your mind with the Word until God’s voice is louder than every lie. Acknowledge what is toxic — do not cover it. Set boundaries. Give the entire situation to Jesus Christ. This is your deliverance moment. Trust Him with what you release. He is faithful, and He is enough.

You have authority. Use it. Break the cycle. Walk away from what is not of God. The same power that raised Christ from the dead lives in you. This is your deliverance moment.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
zugos (ζυγός)	Yoke (Gal 5:1). The wooden beam joining two oxen. Whatever you are yoked to sets your direction, your pace, and how far you can turn your head. Ask yourself what is setting your pace.
stekete (στήκετε)	Stand firm. A soldier holding a position under pressure. Present imperative — keep standing, keep standing, keep standing. It is not one act of courage. It is a thousand.
deilia (δειλία)	Fear (2 Tim 1:7). Not reverent fear. Cowardice — the spirit that runs and hides. God did not give it to you, which means Someone else did, and you may refuse it.
sophronismos (σωφρονισμός)	Sound mind. Literally a saved, disciplined mind — self-mastery. The opposite of the frantic, obsessive, spiraling thought life codependency produces.
eleutheria (ἐλευθερία)	Freedom. In the Greek world, the legal status of a freed slave who could never be re-enslaved. Christ did not loosen the chain. He changed your legal status.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Jim Cress, the Christian counselor who works alongside Lysa TerKeurst, teaches that we are only as sick as our secrets. The chain stays fastened in the dark. Naming it out loud to one safe person is often the first turn of the key.

Timothy Keller defined an idol as any good thing turned into an ultimate thing. A person can be a wonderful gift and a terrible god. Codependency is not usually a love problem. It is a worship problem.

REFLECTION

1. What has kept you stuck in this relationship, situation, or pattern — fear of being alone, financial dependence, loss of identity, hope that “they will change,” or something else? Name it specifically and honestly. No more hiding.
2. Looking at what you wrote above, which parts are from God (peace, conviction, wisdom) and which parts are rooted in fear, control, or codependency? Be willing to separate the two.
3. If you fully believed “I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me” (Philippians 4:13 AMP), what bold decision, boundary, or step of obedience would you make today? Write it out as if you are already walking in that strength.
4. Who or what have you turned from a good gift into an ultimate thing? Say the sentence out loud: “____ is a gift. ____ is not my God.”

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF DELIVERANCE

In the name of Jesus Christ, I break every chain of codependency, fear, and idolatry over my life. I renounce every agreement I made with the lie that I need this person more than I need You. I am not a slave. I am a freed daughter, and I refuse the yoke again. Fill the space where that person sat with Your presence, and give me a sound, disciplined mind in place of the spiraling. The same power that raised You from the dead lives in me. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I am not designed to need any person more than I need God Jesus Christ. He is my Provider, my Protector, my Peace. The chain is broken today.

Section Six — The Unseen Hour

Repetition, discipline, building good habits, and cutting the ones that are killing you

“But when you pray, go into your most private room, and closing the door, pray to your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.”

— Matthew 6:6 AMP

“So that your fasting will not be noticed by people, but by your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.”

— Matthew 6:18 AMP

“But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.”

— Matthew 6:6 KJV

“But when you pray, go away by yourself, shut the door behind you, and pray to your Father in private. Then your Father, who sees everything, will reward you.”

— Matthew 6:6 NLT

THE THIRTY-SECOND OBEDIENCE

A man could not lose the weight. He had tried everything and nothing moved. So he went to his mentor, and his mentor did not hand him a diet or a program. He handed him an assignment.

Buy the gym membership. Drive there. Park the car. Walk inside. Stand there thirty seconds. Drive home. Do that every day for one week.

The man thought it was foolish. He did it anyway. Day one: thirty seconds. Day two, without being told to, he stayed a full minute. Day three, longer. By the end of that week he was staying thirty minutes — and he never stopped. That week changed the entire direction of his life.

The mentor was never building a workout. He was building a man who shows up.

Now hear me, because this is the whole reason I put that story in this planner. **Do not open your Bible today with the goal of being transformed.** That pressure is exactly what has made you quit every other time. Open it. Read one verse. Close it. That is your thirty seconds.

Then do it again tomorrow. God is not measuring the length of your quiet hour. **He is watching whether you came back.**

And here is where this leaves every self-help book on the shelf behind it. The gym story explains the mechanism. It does not supply the power. Paul writes: work out your own salvation with fear and trembling — for it is God who is effectively at work in you, both to will and to work for His good pleasure (Philippians 2:12-13 AMP). Both are true in the same breath. Your feet on the gym floor. His strength in the room. You show up. He does what only He can do.

A TESTIMONY OF DISCIPLINE

Look at every person who reached the top of their field and stayed there — they did not graduate out of the fundamentals. They returned to them daily, long after they had “made it.” That is not a coincidence. That is the actual mechanism of lasting success.

The greatest athletes still run drills. The most anointed preachers still study the Word like new believers. The most effective leaders still practice humility, integrity, and private obedience. They understand a powerful truth: greatness is not built in the spotlight — it is forged in the secret place, day after day, when no one is watching.

This is why we return to the basics in this seeking room. Not because we are beginners, but because we refuse to drift. The fundamentals are not beneath us — they are what carry us. The quiet time. The surrendered heart. The daily choice to open the Word before we open our mouths. The habit of choosing God over comfort, truth over feelings, obedience over convenience.

Jesus Himself modeled this. Even after miracles, crowds, and public ministry, He consistently withdrew to lonely places to pray (Luke 5:16). He never outgrew dependence on the Father.

True spiritual maturity is not moving past the fundamentals — it is living them so deeply they become part of who you are.

A WORD FROM RHINA

Many want a snap of a miracle but are not willing to put in the time. Jesus my God, Lord, and Savior is not an ATM or a vending machine. You cannot have it your way and refuse to glorify the King of kings. This is where real transformation happens — when you give your time fully to God in **the secret place**, behind a closed door, where no one is applauding.

This is the unglamorous, behind-the-scenes work. This is where you return to the fundamentals. Like Vince Lombardi held up the ball every single season and said, “Gentlemen, this is a football,” we must come back to the throne room and say, “This is the Bible. This is the Word of God.” No performance. No “look how spiritual I am.” Just quiet surrender. Just obedience.

God Jesus Christ is not keeping score — He already paid it all on the Cross. But He delights in our obedience. He uses it to build habits that shape us into the women He has called us to be. Real growth doesn’t come from one emotional moment. It comes from daily sowing.

Think of the farmer. If he wants tomatoes, he plants tomato seeds. Then he waters. He fertilizes. He waits. There are no shortcuts. The harvest takes time. Even when nothing is visible above the ground, he keeps showing up because he trusts the process.

The same principle is seen in the life of Joseph. Sold into slavery by his own brothers, falsely accused, and thrown into prison for years — Joseph could have become bitter and quit. Instead, he remained faithful in the hidden place. He worked hard. He served well. He trusted God even when the dream looked impossible. He never stopped honoring the Lord with his actions. While in prison, he interpreted dreams and stewarded his small assignments with excellence. What looked like wasted years was actually God’s preparation. In due time, Joseph was elevated to second in command over all of Egypt — positioned to save nations, including the family that betrayed him.

And look at **Daniel**. When the decree was signed that would cost him his life, the Bible says he went to his upstairs room, knelt, and prayed — “**as he had been doing previously**” (Daniel 6:10). His habit was so deep that a death threat did not interrupt it. He did not need to work up courage in the crisis. The courage was already built, one ordinary morning at a time, long before the lions.

As John Maxwell said, “In order to do what I do, you have to be willing to do what I did.” The private discipline. The hidden hours. The faithful obedience when no one is watching.

BUILDING THE HABIT — SMALL, FAITHFUL, REPEATED

God has never once despised a small beginning. He named it as the thing worth rejoicing over.

“Do not despise these small beginnings, for the Lord rejoices to see the work begin.”

— Zechariah 4:10 NLT

“He who is faithful in a very little thing is also faithful in much.”

— Luke 16:10 AMP

Read Luke 16:10 again, slowly. Jesus is not saying the little thing is a test you must pass to earn the big thing. He is saying **the little thing is the same thing**. The woman who is faithful for thirty seconds is already the woman who will be faithful for thirty minutes. She just has not met herself yet.

And when you miss three days? Proverbs 24:16 — a righteous man falls seven times and rises again. **The righteousness is not in the standing. It is in the rising.** Do not restart on Monday. Restart on the next breath.

- PICK ONE THING. Not five. One verse, one prayer, one page. Five habits is a fantasy. One habit is a life.
- MAKE IT SMALLER THAN YOU THINK IT SHOULD BE. If it feels embarrassing how small it is, it is the right size.
- ATTACH IT TO SOMETHING YOU ALREADY DO. Before the first sip of coffee. After you buckle the last car seat.
- SAME TIME. SAME PLACE. Your body will learn the room before your heart does.
- DO NOT NEGOTIATE IN THE MOMENT. Decide once, at full strength, so you are not deciding at 6am at half strength.
- MISSING ONCE IS AN EVENT. MISSING TWICE IS A PATTERN. Never miss twice.
- COUNT WHAT YOU DID, NOT WHAT YOU FELT. Feelings follow obedience. They do not lead it.

CUTTING THE BAD HABIT — YOU CANNOT JUST STOP. YOU MUST REPLACE.

Here is where most Christian women fail, and it is not for lack of trying. We sweep the house. We repent, we delete the app, we block the number, we throw out the bottle — and we leave the room empty. Jesus warned us exactly what happens next.

“Then it says, “I will return to my house from which I came”; and when it comes, it finds the place unoccupied, swept, and put in order. Then it goes and brings with it seven other spirits more wicked than itself, and they go in and make their home there. And the last condition of that man becomes worse than the first.”

— Matthew 12:44–45 AMP

Swept and empty is not victory. Swept and empty is an invitation. The Word never tells you to only put something off. Every single time, it is a pair.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>Put OFF → Put ON</i>	Ephesians 4:22–24. Strip off the old self like filthy clothing and put on the new. Paul never says undress and stand there.
<i>apothesthai</i> (ἀποθέσθαι)	Put off. To strip off a garment and lay it down. A deliberate act of the hands, not a wish of the heart.
<i>endusasthai</i> (ἐνδύσασθαι)	Put on. To clothe yourself. Same verb used for putting on armor. You do not go into battle naked because you took off your pajamas.
<i>nekrosate</i> (νεκρώσατε)	Colossians 3:5 — “put to death.” Not manage. Not moderate. Not balance. Kill it. The Word does not negotiate with what is killing you.
<i>Replace the ritual</i>	Every bad habit is answering a real question: soothe me, distract me, tell me I matter. Do not remove the answer without giving your soul a better one. Scripture in place of the scroll. Worship in place of the drink. Prayer in place of the text you keep almost sending.

John Owen said it in the plainest words anyone ever has: be killing sin, or it will be killing you. There is no cease-fire. There is no arrangement. There is only which one of you is dying today.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>tameion (ταμείον)</i>	The “inner room” or “closet” of Matthew 6:6. It is the storeroom — the innermost windowless chamber where a household locked away its grain and its treasure. Jesus did not say go find a quiet spot. He said go to the room where the valuables are kept. Your secret place with Him is where the treasure is stored.
<i>blepo en to krup to (βλέπω ἐν τῷ κρυπτῷ)</i>	He “sees in secret.” Blepo is not a glance. It is sustained, attentive watching. This is El Roi — the God Who Sees Me of Genesis 16 — standing in the Greek of Matthew 6. The God who saw Hagar in the wilderness is the same God watching you at 5am with a cold cup of coffee and no audience.
<i>gegumnasmena (γεγυμνασμένα)</i>	Hebrews 5:14 — the mature have their senses “trained by practice.” The root is gymnao, from which we get gymnasium. Scripture already describes discipleship as the gym. You are not being dramatic. You are being biblical.
<i>musar (מוסר)</i>	Hebrew for discipline. It does not mean punishment. It means formative instruction — the shaping that produces character in someone God intends to trust with something.
<i>chanak (חנך)</i>	Proverbs 22:6, “train up.” The root sense is to narrow, to dedicate, and — in ancient usage — to rub the palate of an infant with date syrup so the child develops a taste and begins to suck. Habit is appetite-training. You are teaching your soul what to crave.
<i>hupopiazō (ὕπωπιάζω)</i>	1 Corinthians 9:27 — “I discipline my body.” Literally: I strike it under the eye. It is a boxer’s word. Paul, describing his walk with God, reached for athletic training vocabulary. So did his mentor’s mentor. So can you.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Dallas Willard gave us the sentence that dismantles the shame in this whole section: ***grace is opposed to earning, not to effort.*** You are not working for your salvation. You are working from it. Effort is not the enemy of grace. Earning is.

John Chrysostom, preaching on Matthew 6:6 in the fourth century, said the inner room is not only a place but a disposition — you may be surrounded by a crowd and still be shut in the closet with God. Single mother, hear that. You do not need the empty house you do not have.

Charles Spurgeon said that what a woman is on her knees before God, that she is, and nothing more. Not what she posts. Not what she is called. What she is in the room with the door shut.

SCRIPTURE TO ANCHOR YOU

- “But when you pray, go into your most private room, and closing the door, pray to your Father who is in secret; and your Father who sees in secret will reward you.” (Matthew 6:6 AMP)
- “He who is faithful in a very little thing is also faithful in much.” (Luke 16:10 AMP)
- “Do not despise these small beginnings, for the Lord rejoices to see the work begin.” (Zechariah 4:10 NLT)
- “But solid food is for the mature, whose senses are trained by practice to distinguish between what is morally good and what is evil.” (Hebrews 5:14 AMP)
- “For a righteous man falls seven times and rises again.” (Proverbs 24:16 AMP)
- “Do not be deceived, God is not mocked; for whatever a man sows, that he will also reap.” (Galatians 6:7 AMP)
- “And let us not grow weary while doing good, for in due season we shall reap if we do not lose heart.” (Galatians 6:9 NKJV)

There are no shortcuts to becoming the woman whose life glorifies Jesus. Plant the right seeds. Water them with the Word. Stay faithful in the waiting and in the prison seasons. The harvest is coming — but only for those who refuse to quit.

YOUR THIRTY SECONDS

Write it here. Be embarrassingly small.

- The one habit I am starting: _____
- How small it is (be specific — one verse? two minutes?):

- When and where, exactly: _____
- What I already do that it will attach to: _____
- The one habit I am putting to death: _____
- What I will put ON in its place — not nothing, something:

- If I miss a day, here is what I will NOT do: _____

REFLECTION

1. What does your current morning routine actually look like right now? Be honest — no editing, no spiritualizing it. What is the first thing you reach for when you wake up?
2. What is one non-negotiable habit you will commit to practicing daily — even when no one sees it but God? Write it clearly and specifically.
3. As you build these private habits, what promotion, breakthrough, or greater assignment do you sense God may be preparing you for in this unseen season? How is He using this time to shape your character?
4. What bad habit have you tried to sweep out without putting anything in its place? What real need was that habit meeting — comfort, escape, control, feeling wanted?
5. What will you put ON in that empty room? Be concrete. “I will pray” is not concrete. “When I reach for my phone at 11pm, I will open Psalm 34 instead” is concrete.
6. Daniel prayed “as he had been doing previously” on the day it could have killed him. What habit do you want built into you before your next crisis arrives?
7. Where have you quit because it felt too small to matter? What would change if you believed God rejoices to see the work begin?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF THE SECRET PLACE

Father, I come into the room where the door is shut and no one is watching but You. I bring You my thirty seconds. It is small and I am not ashamed of it, because Your Word says You rejoice to see the work begin. Train my hands. Train my appetite. Teach my soul to crave what is good. I put off the habit that is killing me and I put on Christ in its place — I will not leave that room swept and empty. Give me the strength to come back tomorrow, and the day after, when the feeling is gone and only the obedience is left. You see in secret. That is enough. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

What I practice in private, God will reward in public. I will not skip the unseen hour. I will not despise the small beginning. I will not leave the room swept and empty — I put on Christ. And when I fall, I rise again.

Section Seven — Build the Vision

Faith-based vision writing — not manifesting, not affirmations. Obedience with a pen.

“Write the vision and engrave it plainly on tablets so that the one who reads it will run.”

— Habakkuk 2:2 AMP

“Write the vision, and make it plain upon tables, that he may run that readeth it.”

— Habakkuk 2:2 KJV

A WORD FROM RHINA

This is not “manifesting.” This is not chanting affirmations or trying to speak things into existence by your own power. God has one clear instruction for us: **“Write the vision and engrave it plainly on tablets so that the one who reads it will run”** (Habakkuk 2:2 AMP).

Write it down. Do not just think it. There is something powerful that happens spiritually and mentally when God’s promise moves from your mind to the page. A vision spoken and written once is a wish. A vision spoken and written daily becomes conviction.

This is about building habits that grow our faith. Everything in the Kingdom operates by pattern and cause and effect. When we consistently return to the Word, pray, obey, and write what God has spoken, our faith is strengthened. We begin to see with spiritual eyes.

Jesus made this clear: “I assure you and most solemnly say to you, whoever says to this mountain, ‘Be lifted up and thrown into the sea!’ and does not doubt in his heart, but believes that what he says is going to take place, it will be done for him.” (Mark 11:23 AMP)

But notice — this faith is rooted in God’s will, not our desires. The secret sauce is not in our words alone. It is in aligning our hearts with **God’s** plan and trusting Him completely.

Write the vision God has placed in your heart. If it stays in your mind 24/7, if it will not leave you alone, that is often the Holy Spirit calling you to move. God does not give us dreams to frustrate us — He gives them so we will partner with Him. One day He will ask, just like in the Parable of the Talents: “What did you do with what I gave you?” (Matthew 25:14–30 AMP). He will not ask if you felt spiritual. He will ask what you did with the vision, the talents, and the time He entrusted to you.

Remember, provision also flows from this place of obedience. When Jesus called His disciples, they left their nets — yet He supernaturally provided (the miracle of the fish in Luke 5 and John 21). We work, we tithe, we honor God as our Source, but we are not slaves to money. Jehovah Jireh is our Provider.

Practical habit: Every day, write what God has spoken to you that has not yet happened — as if it already has, because you believe His Word. Make it plain. Run with it. Trust the process. The same God who told Habakkuk to write the vision is the same God who is faithful to bring it to pass in His perfect timing.

Plant the seed. Water it with prayer and obedience. Stay faithful. The harvest is coming.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>kathab</i> (כָּתַב)	Write. An imperative. God did not suggest journaling. He commanded a record.
<i>ba'ar</i> (בָּאֵר)	Make it plain / engrave. To dig, to cut in, to make unmistakably clear. Not pretty handwriting. Deep, permanent marks. A vision you can read while running past it.
<i>luach</i> (לוח)	Tablets. The same word used for the tablets of the Ten Commandments. Stone, not sand. What God speaks is meant to outlast your mood.
<i>ruwts</i> (רוץ)	Run. The vision is written not so you can admire it but so you can move at speed. Writing it is not the finish line. It is the starting block.
<i>chazon</i> (חֲזוֹן)	Vision. From a root meaning to see, to perceive, to receive revelation. It is not your ambition. It is His revelation. There is a world of difference, and only one of them will stand.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

This is where we part ways with the world. The manifestation teacher says: speak it and the universe obeys you. Scripture says: God speaks and you obey Him. In one, you are the source. In the other, He is. One of those makes you god, and it is not the one that saves.

Habakkuk 2:3 — the verse immediately after — says the vision is for an appointed time and though it lingers, wait for it. God attached a delay to the very command to write. The waiting is not evidence He forgot. It was in the instructions from the beginning.

BEFORE YOU WRITE — EIGHT REASONS A PRAYER GOES UNANSWERED

Before you write one word of vision, we must deal with something, because a woman can write the vision for years and hear nothing back and quietly conclude that God does not answer her.

He does. But Scripture is not silent about why heaven sometimes stays quiet. **God is not withholding. He is correcting.** And He tells us plainly what needs to be corrected — not to shame us, but because a Father who says nothing while His daughter walks the wrong way is not a good Father.

Go through these slowly. Ask the Holy Spirit which one is yours. Do not guess. Ask.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
1. UNCONFESED SIN	“If I regard wickedness in my heart, the Lord will not hear.” (Psalm 66:18 AMP) Not sin you fell into — sin you are protecting, hiding, and intend to keep. Isaiah 59:2 says it separates, and that His face is hidden. Confess it and the line opens.
2. UNFORGIVENESS	“Whenever you stand praying, if you have anything against anyone, forgive him.” (Mark 11:25 AMP) Jesus put this immediately after the mountain-moving promise you just read. You cannot hold a grudge in one hand and a promise in the other.
3. WRONG MOTIVES	“You ask and do not receive, because you ask with wrong motives, so that you may spend it on your pleasures.” (James 4:3 AMP) Ask honestly: is this for His kingdom or my comfort? Both may be good. Only one is a prayer God has bound Himself to answer.
4. DOUBT AND DOUBLE-MINDEDNESS	“He must ask in faith, without doubting... For such a person ought not to think or expect that he will receive anything from the Lord.” (James 1:6-7 AMP) Doubt is not the same as fear. You may pray afraid. You may not pray while planning for God to fail.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
5. HOW YOU TREAT PEOPLE	“Husbands, live with your wives in an understanding way... so that your prayers will not be hindered.” (1 Peter 3:7 AMP) The word is hindered — cut off, blocked. And Proverbs 21:13: whoever shuts his ear to the cry of the poor will himself call out and not be answered. How you treat people is not separate from your prayer life. It is your prayer life.
6. PRIDE	“God is opposed to the proud, but gives grace to the humble.” (James 4:6 AMP) Opposed. God actively sets Himself against it. The prayer of a proud woman is not unheard — it is resisted.
7. ASKING OUTSIDE HIS WILL	“If we ask anything according to His will, He hears us.” (1 John 5:14 AMP) Sometimes the answer is no because the thing you are begging for would destroy you, and He loves you far too much to hand it over.
8. IT IS SIMPLY NOT TIME	“For the vision is yet for the appointed time... Though it delays, wait for it; for it will certainly come.” (Habakkuk 2:3 AMP) This is not a rebuke. This is the most common answer of all, and it is the hardest. Silence is not always correction. Sometimes silence is the sound of God working on something you cannot see yet.

Notice what is happening in that list. **Seven of the eight are things God is asking you to correct — and every one of them is something He can help you correct today.** The eighth is simply time, and time He will not negotiate.

So before you write, ask Him. ***“Search me, O God, and know my heart... and see if there is any wicked way in me, and lead me in the everlasting way.”*** (Psalm 139:23-24 AMP). Then wait, and let Him name it. Do not name it for yourself out of shame.

And when He shows you, do not despair over it. Repent, receive the forgiveness that is already purchased, and pick your pen back up. The vision is still yours. The delay was never rejection.

REFLECTION

1. Before you write anything: go back through the eight reasons. Which one did the Holy Spirit put His finger on? Write it, confess it, and then answer question two. Do not skip this.
2. What has God spoken to you that has not happened yet? Write it plainly — not vaguely, not spiritually. Plainly enough that someone could read it while running past.
3. Is this vision His revelation or my ambition? Be honest. How do you know the difference?
4. What have you stopped writing down because the waiting embarrassed you?
5. Habakkuk 2:3 says the vision is for an appointed time. What would change today if you truly believed the delay was in the instructions, not evidence of failure?
6. The Parable of the Talents asks what you did with what He gave you. What has He already placed in your hands that you have buried?
7. If this vision came to pass exactly as God spoke it, what would you need to become between now and then? Start becoming her today.

DAILY VISION WRITING PAGES

Each day, write what God has spoken to you that hasn't happened yet — as if it already has. Two days per page.

DAY 1 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 2 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 3 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 4 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 5 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 6 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 7 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 8 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 9 — WRITE THE VISION

DAY 10 — WRITE THE VISION

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF THE WRITTEN VISION

Jesus Christ, I will not manifest. I will obey. Show me what You have actually spoken, and give me the courage to cut it deep and plain so I can run with it. Where I have written my own ambition and called it Your revelation, correct me. Where I stopped writing because the waiting humiliated me, restore my hand to the page. The vision is for an appointed time. I will wait, and I will keep writing. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I write the vision and I make it plain. This is not my ambition — it is God's revelation. It is for an appointed time, and I will run with it when He says run.

Section Eight — Seeking the Kingdom First

What it actually means to put Jesus Christ first, before your healing, your provision, and your plans

“But first and most importantly seek (aim at, strive after) His kingdom and His righteousness (His way of doing and being right — the attitude and character of God), and all these things will be given to you also.”

— Matthew 6:33 AMP

“But seek ye first the kingdom of God, and his righteousness; and all these things shall be added unto you.”

— Matthew 6:33 KJV

“Seek the Kingdom of God above all else, and live righteously, and he will give you everything you need.”

— Matthew 6:33 NLT

A WORD FROM RHINA

For a long time I thought “seek first the kingdom” meant pray in the morning and read a verse before bed. I was wrong. Seeking the kingdom first means Jesus Christ is the first place I run, not the last resort after I have exhausted every other plan. It means He gets my first thought when I wake up afraid, not my third or fourth, after I have already spiraled, already texted everyone, already tried to fix it myself.

Here is what nobody told me as a single mom drowning in bills, custody stress, and a broken heart: the kingdom of God is not a reward you get after your life is in order. It is the order. Jesus Christ said seek it FIRST — not seek stability first, not seek a new relationship first, not seek the next paycheck first, and then He fits in around it. He is not asking to be added to your list. He is asking to be the list.

The word “seek” in the Amplified translation means to aim at, to strive after. That is active. That is not a passive feeling of faith — it is a daily, repeated decision to chase Jesus Christ harder than you chase the outcome you want. And the promise attached to it is not vague. “All these things will be given to you also.” Provision, direction, healing, the next step — it is not earned by your striving for it directly. It is the overflow of seeking Him first.

Single mom, hear me: you do not have the margin to chase the kingdom last. You are too tired, too stretched, carrying too much, to keep putting Jesus Christ at the bottom of an already impossible list. Flip the order. Watch what He does with everything underneath it.

SEEK. AND THEN KEEP SEEKING. UNTIL WHEN?

Now you know what He asks of you. Section Seven showed you the eight things that block a prayer. Section Six showed you how a habit is built — thirty seconds at a time, coming back when no one applauds.

So here is the question every woman eventually asks, usually at 2am, usually crying: ***how long do I have to keep doing this?***

The Greek answers it before you finish asking. **Zeteite — “seek” in Matthew 6:33 — is a present active imperative.** In English we have no clean way to say it. The closest is: ***“keep on seeking, and keep on seeking, and do not stop seeking.”***

It is the same tense in Matthew 7:7. Not ask once, seek once, knock once. **Keep asking. Keep seeking. Keep knocking.** Jesus built the answer into the grammar. The seeking was never supposed to end.

So: until when? **Until forever.** Not because God is withholding and must be worn down — He is not a reluctant judge — but because seeking Him is not the price of the relationship. Seeking Him IS the relationship.

“Seek the Lord and His strength; seek His face continually [longing to be in His presence].”

— 1 Chronicles 16:11 AMP

“One thing I have asked of the Lord, and that I will seek: that I may dwell in the house of the Lord all the days of my life.”

— Psalm 27:4 AMP

Read David again. He does not ask to visit. He asks to dwell — all the days of his life. **The man had already found God. He kept seeking Him anyway.**

And Paul, decades into ministry, after the third heaven, after the shipwrecks, after writing half the New Testament, still wrote: ***“that I may know Him.”*** (Philippians 3:10). He was not a beginner asking for an introduction. He was an old man in a cell who had found what he wanted and discovered it had no bottom.

Here is why there is no end. **God is infinite.** Gregory of Nyssa, writing in the fourth century, called this ***epektasis*** — the eternal stretching forward. He taught that because God has no limit, the soul that finds Him does not arrive; it begins. Every discovery of God opens onto more God. Forever. This is not the sad news that you will never finish. It is the good news that there is no bottom to the One who loves you.

So stop waiting to graduate. There is no page in this planner where you will finally be done seeking, because there is no day in eternity where you will finally be done with Him.

Seek Him because He answered you. Seek Him because He has not yet. Seek Him on the morning it all works and on the morning nothing does. Seek Him at thirty seconds and seek Him at thirty years. **And when you are old and He has given you everything He promised — seek Him still. That is not the cost of the Christian life. That is the reward of it.**

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>zeteo (ζητέω)</i>	Seek. Present imperative — keep on seeking, continuously, as a way of life. It is the word for searching for something lost that you desperately need, not browsing. And it never once means “think about occasionally.”
<i>proton (πρώτον)</i>	First. Not first in a sequence — first in rank. It is not about what you do at 6am. It is about what governs everything you do at every hour.
<i>basileia (βασιλεία)</i>	Kingdom. Not a place — a reign. The active rule of a king. To seek His kingdom is to seek His governance over the exact area you are trying to control yourself.
<i>dikaiosune (δικαιοσύνη)</i>	Righteousness. Right standing and right conduct. Not perfection — alignment. His way of doing and being right, in the decision you are facing right now.
<i>prostithemi (προστίθηναι)</i>	“Added.” To place alongside, to throw in. It is not payment for services rendered. It is what a good Father throws in on top, because He was always going to.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

C.S. Lewis wrote that if you aim at heaven you get earth thrown in, but if you aim at earth you get neither. That is Matthew 6:33 in one sentence.

Notice the context. Matthew 6:33 sits in the middle of Jesus teaching about anxiety — birds, lilies, do not worry about tomorrow. He gave this command to worried people about their real needs. Food. Clothing. He is not scolding your fear. He is reordering it.

REFLECTION

1. Be honest: what do you currently seek first, before you ever pray about it — control, a person, an answer, a plan? Name it without shame.
2. What would it practically look like, this week, to seek Jesus Christ FIRST instead of last — before the phone, before the group text, before you try to fix it yourself?
3. What “things” are you waiting on God to add to your life? Write them out as a prayer list, not a demand list.
4. What does “His righteousness” — His way of doing and being right — look like in a decision you are facing right now, even if it is not the easiest path?
5. “Kingdom” means His active reign. What is the one area you are still ruling yourself, and refusing to hand over?

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF REORDERING

Jesus Christ, forgive me for the order I have had things in. I have sought comfort first, control first, answers first, and brought You in after. Today I reorder my life around You. You are not the last call I make when everything else fails — You are the first. I seek Your kingdom and Your righteousness above my need for security, above my need for a resolution, above my need to understand. I hand You the one area I have been ruling myself. I trust that everything else I need will be added, because Your Word does not return void. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

***I seek the kingdom of Jesus Christ first — not last, not leftover.
Everything I need, He has already promised to add. My job is to seek.
His job is to provide.***

Section Nine — The Blessing That Is Already Yours

Walking in the inheritance of Deuteronomy 28, obedience, and what it means to live blessed and not cursed

“Now it shall be, if you diligently listen to and obey the voice of the Lord your God, being careful to do all His commandments which I am commanding you today, the Lord your God will set you high above all the nations of the earth. All these blessings will come upon you and overtake you if you pay attention to the voice of the Lord your God.”

— Deuteronomy 28:1-2 AMP

A WORD FROM RHINA

When my marriage ended, I did not feel blessed. I felt forgotten. I looked at Deuteronomy 28 and thought, that is for people whose lives are working. Not for a single mom counting every dollar, explaining to her children why their family looks different now, lying awake doing math at midnight. But God Jesus Christ corrected that thinking in me. The blessing was never about my circumstances looking perfect. It was about my obedience and my position in Him — and from that position, the blessing was already being released, whether I could see it yet or not.

Deuteronomy 28 is not a name-it-claim-it formula. Read it slowly and you will see the order: obedience, then blessing. Not the blessing first as proof God loves you, and not the blessing as something you manufacture through positive words alone. The blessing follows a life surrendered to Him — verses 3 through 13 describe being blessed in the city and in the field, blessed coming in and going out, blessed in your work, your finances, your children, your future. That is not a promise reserved for women whose marriages stayed intact. That is a promise for a daughter of the King who is walking in obedience right where she is, today, single or not.

There is also a sobering half of this chapter — verses 15 and beyond describe the curse that follows disobedience. I am not going to soften that or skip it, because the Word does not skip it. But hear this clearly: a hard season, a divorce, a betrayal someone else committed against you, is not evidence that you are cursed. The curses described in this chapter are tied to willful disobedience, not to being sinned against. Do not let shame twist this chapter into a weapon against yourself. Let it instead show you the God who is serious about blessing the obedient and serious about protecting His daughter from a counterfeit life.

You are not waiting for the blessing to arrive someday. If you belong to Jesus Christ and you are walking in obedience to what He has shown you, the blessing is already yours by inheritance. Your job is not to manufacture it. Your job is to walk in it, expect it, and refuse every lie that tells you it skipped you.

THE BLESSING WAS THERE FROM THE FIRST PAGE

Deuteronomy 28 is not where the blessing starts. It is where it is restated. Go all the way back.

“And God blessed them and said to them, “Be fruitful, multiply, and fill the earth, and subjugate it [putting it under your power].””

— Genesis 1:28 AMP

Look at the order, because it will change how you carry yourself for the rest of your life. **God blessed them BEFORE they had done anything.** Before a single act of obedience. Before one work, one word, one prayer. The blessing was not a wage paid for performance. It was the first thing He said over them, and He said it while they were brand new and had accomplished nothing.

That is the God you are dealing with. **He blesses first, and then He asks.** Deuteronomy 28 comes four books later, and it is not a change of His nature. It is a restatement to a people who had forgotten who they already were.

And notice what the enemy did with it. He did not come to Eve and say, “God has not blessed you.” He came and said, “Did God really say?” (Genesis 3:1). He never denies the blessing. He only questions whether you heard God right about it. That is still his one move. He has not learned a second.

So when the voice comes and says the blessing skipped you, that your divorce disqualified you, that women whose marriages held are the ones God speaks over — **recognize the accent. You have heard it before. It was in a garden.**

WHAT THEY MEANT FOR EVIL, GOD MEANT FOR GOOD

“As for you, you meant evil against me, but God meant it for good in order to bring about this present outcome, that many people would be kept alive [as they are this day].”

— Genesis 50:20 AMP

“But as for you, ye thought evil against me; but God meant it unto good, to bring to pass, as it is this day, to save much people alive.”

— Genesis 50:20 KJV

“You intended to harm me, but God intended it all for good. He brought me to this position so I could save the lives of many people.”

— Genesis 50:20 NLT

This is Joseph, standing in front of the brothers who sold him. He is not pretending it was not evil. Read it again — he says the word. Evil. He does not spiritualize what they did. He does not tell them it was fine. It was not fine.

And then he says the sentence that has held me together on nights I could not hold myself together: **but God meant it for good.**

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
chashab (חָשַׁב)	The Hebrew word used TWICE in this verse — for what the brothers did and for what God did. It means to weave, to reckon, to devise a plan. The exact same verb. They wove evil. God wove good. Out of the identical thread.
ra'ah (רָאָה)	Evil, calamity, harm. Joseph does not soften it and neither should you. What was done to you was evil. Naming it correctly is not bitterness. It is honesty.
tobah (טוֹבָה)	Good, welfare, benefit. The same root as when God looked at creation and said it was good. He did not make the evil good. He made good out of it.

Hear the distinction, because everything rests on it. God did not author the evil. He is not the one who sold Joseph. He is not the one who betrayed you, who lied to you, who walked out on you and your children. What He did was take what was woven for your destruction and weave it into something that would save many lives — and He did it without ever calling the evil good.

It took thirteen years. Slavery, false accusation, prison, forgotten by the man he helped. **Joseph did not say this sentence in the pit. He said it in the palace, decades later, looking backward.** You may not be able to say it yet. That is not faithlessness. That is Tuesday. Say it when you can see it. Until then, hold on to the God who is already weaving.

And then hear what Joseph says next, in verse 21: ***“So now, do not be afraid; I will provide for you and your little ones.”*** The man they tried to kill fed them. That is not weakness and it is not a lack of boundaries — Joseph tested those brothers thoroughly before he ever revealed himself. That is a man so secure in what God did with his story that his brothers no longer had any power in it.

One day you will tell your story and not flinch. Not because it stopped being evil, but because you finally saw what God wove out of it. And what He wove will keep many people alive — starting with the woman reading it.

The blessing was spoken over you in Genesis 1, before you did anything. It was restated in Deuteronomy 28. And in Genesis 50 we are shown what God does with the worst thing that ever happened to a man He loved. **Your inheritance was never in danger. It was only ever in process.**

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
shama (שָׁמַע)	“Diligently listen.” In Hebrew, hearing and obeying are the same verb. There is no such thing as having heard God and not done it. That is called not having heard.
barak (בָּרַךְ)	Bless. The root means to kneel. A blessing is not a thing handed down from a distance — it is the posture of One who bends down to you.
nasag (נָשַׁג)	“Overtake you.” A hunting and warfare word — to pursue and catch. The blessings are not waiting for you to find them. They are chasing you down.
qelalah (קָלָה)	Curse. From a root meaning to make light, to treat as trivial. To be cursed is to be emptied of weight and significance. Notice: it follows treating God’s word lightly. It does not follow being sinned against.

Sit with that. **The word for blessing means to kneel, and the word for the blessing arriving means to be hunted down and caught.** God kneels toward you and His goodness pursues you like a hunter. That is Psalm 23:6 — goodness and mercy shall follow me — where “follow” is *radaph*, to chase.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Dr. Joel Muddamalle, Director of Theology at Proverbs 31 Ministries, cautions that Scripture is most dangerous when it is lifted out of its context and weaponized — including against ourselves. Deuteronomy 28 was spoken to a covenant people about willful covenant-breaking. It was never given to a betrayed woman as a verdict on her worth.

REFLECTION

1. Where have you believed the lie that your circumstances disqualify you from being blessed? Name it plainly.
2. Read Deuteronomy 28:3–13 in your own Bible. Which specific blessing speaks most directly to what you are believing God for right now?
3. What area of obedience to Jesus Christ have you been putting off because it feels hard, inconvenient, or costly?
4. What would change in how you carry yourself this week if you truly believed you were already blessed, not waiting to become blessed?
5. Have you ever used this chapter as a weapon against yourself? Write the lie you told yourself, then write the truth underneath it.
6. God blessed Adam and Eve before they had done one thing. What changes if the blessing was never a wage you earn, but the first word He spoke over you?
7. Joseph said “you meant evil” and “God meant it for good” in the same breath — without ever calling the evil good. Write the evil plainly. Then, if you can, write what you have seen God weave from it. If you cannot see it yet, write instead: “I cannot see it yet, and I am still His.”
8. Joseph waited thirteen years before he could say that sentence. Where are you in your thirteen years? Be honest — there is no shame in the pit.

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF INHERITANCE

In the name of Jesus Christ, I receive the blessing You have already declared over my life. I am blessed in this city and in this season. I am blessed coming in and blessed going out. I am blessed in my work, my finances, my children, and my future. I refuse the lie that my circumstances disqualify me from Your promises. I refuse to use Your Word as a weapon against my own soul. I walk in obedience to what You have shown me, and I expect the blessing of Deuteronomy 28 to overtake me, just as Your Word says it will. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I am blessed coming in and blessed going out. The inheritance of Deuteronomy 28 belongs to me through obedience to Jesus Christ. I am not cursed by what was done to me. I am the blessed daughter of a faithful God, and I walk in that identity today.

Section Ten — The Fence Was Always Love

Boundaries, levels of access, honor, and the difference between safety and isolation

“And the Lord God commanded the man, saying, “You may freely (unconditionally) eat the fruit from every tree of the garden; but you shall not eat from the tree of the knowledge (recognition) of good and evil; for on the day that you eat from it, you shall most certainly die.””

— Genesis 2:16–17 AMP

“Watch over your heart with all diligence, for from it flow the springs of life.”

— Proverbs 4:23 AMP

“Guard your heart above all else, for it determines the course of your life.”

— Proverbs 4:23 NLT

A WORD FROM RHINA

Of all the subjects God could have chosen for His first recorded conversation with a human being — worship, purpose, marriage, work, His own name — He chose boundaries.

Read Genesis 2 again. Before the fall. Before sin. Before a single thing had gone wrong in the world. God walks up to the man in a perfect garden and speaks about what he may have and what he may not touch. Lysa TerKeurst points this out and it undid me: the very first conversation between God and man was about a boundary. And that boundary was not restriction. It was protection.

Look at the ratio God set. **Every tree — freely, unconditionally — except one.** A boundary is not a small life. It is a wide-open garden with one fence in it. Anyone who tells you that a woman with boundaries is a woman who has closed herself off has never read Genesis 2.

So let me say plainly what took me years to learn: **boundaries are not walls. They are not punishment. They are not the silent treatment with a Bible verse attached.** A wall keeps everyone out. A boundary decides who comes in, how far, and on what terms.

Lysa says boundaries are not meant to shove other people away — they are meant to hold us together, so that we stop trying to control other people and start biblically holding ourselves accountable to remaining self-controlled. Read that twice. A boundary is not something you install in someone else. It is something you install in yourself.

And that is why they feel so terrifying. A boundary means I stop managing you and start governing me.

LEVELS OF ACCESS, LEVELS OF RESPONSIBILITY

Here is what changed everything for me. Access and responsibility are supposed to be proportionate.

Lysa observed it running all through Scripture: God gave different people different levels of access to Him, and He required greater responsibility from those He let closer. Not because certain people were more valuable than others — every soul is priceless — but because responsibility must rise with access. When access and responsibility are disproportionate, only chaos can follow.

That was my whole problem. **I was handing out front-door access to people who had never once shown back-door responsibility.** I gave my most tender wounds to people who had not earned the right to hold them. And then I was shocked when I bled.

Jesus Himself lived in levels. Look at it: He taught the crowds. He sent out seventy. He chose twelve. He drew three — Peter, James, and John — up the mountain of transfiguration and into the garden of Gethsemane. And there was one who leaned on His chest at the table. Same Jesus. Same love. Different levels of access.

Jesus loved everyone. Jesus did not tell everyone everything. If perfect love kept levels, your levels are not a failure of love. They are a reflection of it.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
THE CROWD	They get your kindness, your courtesy, your prayers. They do not get your story. This is most people, and that is not cruelty — it is order.
THE SEVENTY	Colleagues, church family, school moms. They get your presence and your service. They do not get your unfiltered grief at 2am.
THE TWELVE	Trusted friends who have shown up over time. They get honesty and access to your real life. They have earned it by consistency, not by wanting it.
THE THREE	The very few who have seen you at your worst and stayed, who tell you the truth, who carry weight without dropping it. Guard this circle ferociously.
THE ONE	God Himself. Only He gets all of you. Every person you have tried to promote into this seat has collapsed under a weight they were never built to carry.

Write the names in. Move someone if you need to. **Demotion is not hatred. It is stewardship.**

BOUNDARIES ARE FOR SAFETY — NOT FOR ISOLATION

I want to be very careful here, because a wounded woman can weaponize this teaching and end up alone in a fortress she built and called obedience.

A boundary is not a punishment you administer. It is not the cold shoulder. It is not a test to see if they will chase you. It is not a lever you pull to change someone's behavior. If you are setting a boundary in order to make them do something, that is not a boundary — that is control wearing a costume.

A boundary sounds like this: ***“I will not participate in a conversation where I am screamed at. If it starts, I will leave the room, and I will be glad to talk tomorrow.”***

Notice what that sentence does. It does not command the other person. **It governs me.** They remain free. So do I.

And the goal, wherever it is possible and safe, is not to lose the person. It is to keep the relationship from destroying both of you. Lysa teaches: take steps, not leaps. We do not leap to the extreme of goodbye. But we do have to acknowledge reality — and when someone consistently brings zero responsibility and keeps repeating a pattern that has moved a relationship from difficult to destructive, then zero access has to be on the table. And we do not do that alone. We need wise people around us.

WHEN IT IS NO LONGER A BOUNDARY — IT IS AN EXIT

Let me be unmistakably clear, because a wrong word here can cost a woman her life.

If you are being physically abused, sexually abused, or if your children are being abused — that is not a situation that calls for a graduated boundary. That is a situation that calls for a door, a lock, and help. Get out. Call for help. God has never once asked a woman to remain in a room where she is being destroyed in order to prove her faith.

Submission is not a synonym for endangerment. Forgiveness is not a synonym for access.

You can forgive a man from a very great distance. You can pray for someone whose number you have blocked. Reconciliation requires two repentant people. Forgiveness requires one obedient one. Do not confuse them, and do not let anyone tell you that you have.

Forgive and release — yes. But “forgive and forget” is not in the Bible. God forgets our sins by choosing not to hold them against us (Hebrews 8:12), not by losing the memory. You are permitted to remember what someone did. Remembering is how you stop walking into it again. What you release is your right to repay them. What you keep is the wisdom their behavior taught you.

And this: **you were never called to walk on eggshells.** That is not peacemaking. That is hostage-keeping. Peace that requires your silence, your shrinking, and your constant self-monitoring is not the peace of Christ. It is a ceasefire you are paying for with your soul.

BUT WHAT ABOUT HONORING MY PARENTS?

This is the question that keeps women trapped, and I will not skip it.

“Honor (respect, obey, care for) your father and your mother, so that your days may be prolonged in the land the Lord your God gives you.”

— Exodus 20:12 AMP

The Hebrew word is *kabad*. And it does not mean what you have been told it means.

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>kabad</i> (כָּבַד)	Honor. The root literally means to be heavy, to have weight. To honor someone is to give them weight — to treat their place in your life as substantial and significant. Its opposite, <i>qalal</i> , means to make light, to treat as trivial.
<i>What kabad IS</i>	Assigning your parents real weight. Speaking of them without contempt. Providing for their needs where you are able. Refusing to erase them or trash them publicly. Honoring the office of mother and father even when the person failed the office.
<i>What kabad IS NOT</i>	Obedience. You are commanded to obey as a child (Ephesians 6:1). You are commanded to honor for life. Those are two different Hebrew and Greek constructions. A grown daughter honors. She does not obey.
<i>What kabad IS NOT</i>	Unlimited access. Nothing in this commandment obligates you to hand an abusive parent your address, your children, or your unguarded heart.
<i>What kabad IS NOT</i>	Silence about the truth. You may honor a parent and still tell a counselor exactly what happened in that house.
<i>timao</i> (τιμάω)	The Greek in Ephesians 6:2, quoting this commandment. It means to estimate the value of, to price something. Honor is the act of assigning correct value — not inflating it, not erasing it. Correct.

So hear me: **we do not cut off our parents simply because they hurt us, disappointed us, or failed us.** That is not the Word, and I will not teach it. Most parents are flawed people who wounded you without ever intending to, and God is capable of restoring things you assume are finished.

But honor is not access, and it never was. You may honor your mother and still not spend Christmas in her house. You may honor your father and still not answer at midnight. You may honor them both and still, in cases of ongoing abuse or danger to your children, love them from a distance so great that it looks like absence — and be in full obedience to Exodus 20:12 while you do it. Give them weight. Do not give them your throat.

JESUS WALKED AWAY

If boundaries were unloving, Jesus was the most unloving man who ever lived. Look at the record.

- NAZARETH. His hometown crowd tried to throw Him off a cliff. He did not stay to explain Himself. “But passing through the crowd, He went on His way.” (Luke 4:30 AMP) He walked out of the middle of them.
- THE GADARENES. After He delivered a demon-possessed man, the whole region begged Him to leave. He did not plead. He did not prove Himself. He got in the boat and left. (Mark 5:17)
- HEROD. Standing before a man who held His life, questioned at length, Jesus “answered him nothing.” (Luke 23:9) Silence is a boundary. You do not owe an explanation to someone who only wants entertainment.
- THE CROWDS. Repeatedly, at the height of demand, “He Himself would often slip away to the wilderness and pray.” (Luke 5:16 AMP) He left needy people unmet in order to be with the Father. So may you.
- THE TEMPLE. He made a whip. He turned tables. Anger at what desecrates a holy space is not the opposite of love — it is love with a spine. (John 2:15)
- JUDAS. He knew. He washed his feet anyway, and He did not stop him. Love does not require you to prevent someone from choosing their own path.

And He asked the question that ends every argument about boundaries: to the man lying by the pool for thirty-eight years He said, **“Do you want to get well?”** (John 5:6). Not everyone does. Some people prefer the pool. And Jesus, God in flesh, did not force a single one of them.

DIG DEEPER — THE ORIGINAL WORDS

Word (Original)	What It Actually Carries
<i>natsar</i> (נָצַר)	Proverbs 4:23, “guard” or “watch over.” A military term — to post a sentry, to garrison a fortress. God assumes there will be attempts on your heart, and He assigns you the watch.
<i>mishmar</i> (מִשְׁמָר)	“With all diligence” — literally, above all guarding. A prison-watch, a night-watch. Not one glance at the gate. A posted, ongoing vigil.
<i>gebul</i> (גְּבוּל)	Boundary / border. Deuteronomy 19:14 forbids moving your neighbor’s boundary stone. God legislated property lines and called their removal wickedness. He has always been serious about lines.
<i>ezer</i> (עֵזֶר)	Genesis 2:18, “helper.” Used elsewhere almost exclusively of God Himself rescuing Israel. It is a warrior word. You were never designed to be a doormat. You were designed to be a strength.
<i>aphiemi</i> (ἀφίημι)	The Greek for forgive. To send away, to release, to let go of a debt. Notice what it does not mean: to invite back in. Forgiveness sends the debt away. It does not send for the debtor.
<i>sophron</i> (σώφρων)	Self-controlled, sober-minded. The New Testament fruit that boundaries actually produce. The point is never their behavior. It is always your steadiness.

WHAT THE THEOLOGIANS SAW

Lysa TerKeurst, president of Proverbs 31 Ministries, says she did not have the biblical confidence as a Christian woman that boundaries were in keeping with Scripture — until she saw that the very first recorded conversation between God and man was about one. Her conclusion, and now mine: ***boundaries are not just a good idea. They are a God idea.***

Jim Cress, the licensed Christian counselor who works alongside Lysa, reminds us that mental health is a commitment to reality at all costs. Not the reality you wish were true about that person. The one that keeps repeating.

Dr. Joel Muddamalle, Proverbs 31's Director of Theology, warns against the weaponizing of misread Scripture to keep women emotionally paralyzed inside destructive relationships. If a verse is being used to keep you in harm's way, it is being used against its Author.

Henri Nouwen wrote that the man who is not able to be alone in solitude will use community to escape himself, and the one who cannot bear community will use solitude to hide. Boundaries are not distance. They are the honest measure of what you can actually carry.

BOUNDARIES SCRIPTURE TO STAND ON

- “Watch over your heart with all diligence, for from it flow the springs of life.” (Proverbs 4:23 AMP)
- “Do not associate with a man given to angry outbursts... or you will learn his ways and entangle yourself in a snare.” (Proverbs 22:24-25 AMP)
- “If possible, as far as it depends on you, live at peace with everyone.” (Romans 12:18 AMP) — note carefully: if possible, and as far as it depends on you. God accounted for the fact that it will not always be possible, and that half of it never depended on you.
- “Do not be so deceived and misled! Evil companionships corrupt and deprave good manners and morals and character.” (1 Corinthians 15:33 AMP)
- “Avoid such people and keep far away from them.” (2 Timothy 3:5 AMP) — Paul commands avoidance. Of religious people, no less.
- “Reject a divisive man after the first and second admonition.” (Titus 3:10 NKJV) — there is a number. It is not seventy times seven for access. That number is for forgiveness.
- “Do not give that which is holy to the dogs, and do not throw your pearls before pigs.” (Matthew 7:6 AMP) — Jesus commands discernment about what you place in whose hands.
- “I have set before you life and death... therefore choose life.” (Deuteronomy 30:19 AMP) — the invitation to choose was always yours.

NAMING YOUR LEVELS

Write it out. Be honest about who currently has access they have not earned, and who has earned access you have not given.

- Who currently has more access to me than they have shown responsibility for? _____
- What specifically will I no longer participate in? _____
- What is the sentence I will say, out loud, that governs ME and not them?

- Who is one wise person walking with me through this? (Do not do it alone.)

- Who have I isolated from out of fear, whom God may be asking me to let back in slowly? _____
- Is there a relationship that has crossed from difficult to destructive? Name it.

- Where have I confused honor with obedience, or forgiveness with access?

REFLECTION

1. Of everything God could have discussed with Adam first, He chose a boundary — and He set it in the middle of a garden of freedom. What does that tell you about His heart toward the limits He has put in your life?
2. Where have you been giving front-door access to someone who has never taken back-door responsibility? Name them, and name what you handed them.
3. Write your own boundary sentence for the hardest relationship you have. It must govern you, not them. If you cannot write it without commanding them, you are still trying to control, not protect.
4. Where have you called control a boundary? Where have you called a wall a boundary? Be brutally honest — God can work with honest.
5. Honor (kabad) means to give weight. Obedience is not required of a grown daughter. Where have you confused the two, and what has that confusion cost you?
6. Forgiveness releases a debt. It does not restore access. Who have you forgiven, and then handed the key back to, and been wounded again?
7. Jesus asked, “Do you want to get well?” Answer Him honestly. Is there any part of you that is comfortable by this pool?
8. Where have you been walking on eggshells and calling it peace? What would it cost you to stop — and what is it already costing you not to?
9. Are you in danger, or are your children? If the answer is yes, this reflection ends here. Close this book. Call someone. God will still be here when you are safe.

JOURNAL SPACE

Take your time here. Write until the page is full — there is no rush in a seeking room.

PRAYER OF THE FENCE

Father, You spoke about a boundary before You spoke about anything else, and You called it love. Teach me to see Your fences the way You built them — not as cages, but as care. Give me the courage to govern myself instead of managing everyone else. Show me who I have let too close and who I have shut out in fear. I forgive, and I release the debt — and I will not hand back the key You told me to keep. Where I have called control a boundary, convict me. Where I have called a wall obedience, tear it down. Teach me to honor my mother and my father with real weight, and to do it from whatever distance keeps me and my children safe. And Jesus, You walked through the middle of the crowd that wanted You dead, and You went on Your way. Give me that same holy freedom to leave. Make me a woman who is safe, peaceful, honorable — and free. In Jesus Christ's name, Amen.

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

God spoke about boundaries before He spoke about anything else — and He called them protection, not punishment. I govern myself. I do not control others. I forgive fully and I do not hand back the key. Honor is not obedience. Forgiveness is not access. Peace is not eggshells. I am not isolated. I am guarded. And the fence was always love.

JANUARY

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness. — Matthew 6:33

JANUARY — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- Time in Prayer: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- My thirty seconds — did I show up? ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

VERSE OF THE MONTH

ONE HABIT I AM BUILDING

ONE HABIT I AM PUTTING TO DEATH

ONE BOUNDARY I KEPT

ONE LIE I REPLACED WITH TRUTH

TODAY I AM THANKFUL FOR

WHAT I PRACTICED PRIVATELY THIS MONTH

FEBRUARY

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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FEBRUARY — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- Time in Prayer: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- My thirty seconds — did I show up? ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

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MARCH

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SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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MARCH — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- Time in Prayer: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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APRIL

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SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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APRIL — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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MAY

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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MAY — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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JUNE

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SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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JUNE — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

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JULY

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SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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JULY — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- Time in Prayer: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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AUGUST

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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AUGUST — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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SEPTEMBER

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SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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SEPTEMBER — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

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OCTOBER

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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OCTOBER — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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NOVEMBER

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

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NOVEMBER — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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WHAT I PRACTICED PRIVATELY THIS MONTH

DECEMBER

Undated. Fill in the dates yourself. Use each box for notes, prayers, or what God is speaking to you that day.

SUN	MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI	SAT

Seek first the kingdom of God and His righteousness. — Matthew 6:33

DECEMBER — MY MONTH WITH GOD

SEEK FIRST TRACKER

- Time in the Word: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
- Time in Prayer: ☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S
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WHAT I PRACTICED PRIVATELY THIS MONTH

Closing — This Is Not the End. This Is Growing.

Closing this planner is not finishing the work. The most successful people you will ever study did not arrive and stop practicing — they built habits and never let them go. The habit is the whole point. The more you return to these pages, the more it sticks. The more it sticks, the more it becomes who you are, not just what you do.

Let the Word of God Jesus Christ continue to change your life. Incline your eyes and your heart toward Him daily — not because you finished a planner, but because seeking Him is the habit that carries you for the rest of your life.

And when you come back to page one tomorrow, or next month, or next season — **you are not starting over. You are coming home.**

SPEAK THIS OUT LOUD

I am not a victim of my circumstances. I am a daughter of the King, with authority, purpose, and a future full of hope. I take captive every thought that does not line up with the Word of God. I will not make a home out of my grief, and I will not call a demon “depression” my identity. I seek God Jesus Christ first — not people, not Sunday, not a group chat. What I practice in private, He will reward in public. I guard my heart and I keep my fences, because the fence was always love. I write the vision. I run with it. My worst chapter is not my last one. This is not the end of my seeking. This is the habit I carry forward.

Continued Journal Pages

Use these final pages to keep going — write what God is speaking, what you're surrendering, and what you're thankful for, for as long as you need.

